valuable inputs on economic policy to the Congress party during the freedom struggle. In 1938, Shroff was invited to be a member of the first Planning Committee constituted by the Congress President Subhas Chandra Bose. Nehru headed the Committee.

Shroff joined Tata Sons as its Financial Adviser in January 1940. At a time when the concept of investment banking was in its infancy, he played a pioneering role in helping to fund new ventures. F.E. Dinshaw had died in 1936 and J.R.D. Tata invited Shroff to take his place as the Financial and Economic Adviser of the Tatas four years later. At that time Tatas were setting up the Investment Corporation of India (ICI), which would not only act as a sort of holding company for the group but also serve as a vehicle for promoting new ventures. The ICI came into being largely due to Shroff's initiative and he was also responsible for its subsequent growth. Shroff was its Managing Director till 1964.

On February 1, 1941, Shroff became a full-time Director of Tata Sons. J.R.D. also prevailed upon Shroff to accept the Chairmanship of the New India Assurance Company in 1946 when Sir Chunilal Mehta retired and that institution's subsequent performance owed much to Shroff's stewardship. Nationalisation of the life insurance industry greatly infuriated both Shroff and J.R.D. Tata but Shroff chose to remain its Chairman till his death in 1965. Shroff's association with the Tatas lasted for two decades till he resigned in 1960.

In 1944, Shroff was also one of the eight eminent persons who authored a document called 'A Plan for the Economic Development of India' popularly known as the Bombay Plan. It was a fifteen-year blueprint for India's post-war economic development and envisaged capital investment of ₹10,000 crore. The controversial plan which sparked off debates and embarrassed the British government proposed rigorous measures of State control and stressed that economic development of the kind proposed could be possible only on the basis of a strong central directing authority. It is surprising that a man so committed to free enterprise was one of the authors of this Plan for it recommended a number of restrictive measures like graduated income tax, price control, ceiling on dividends, and appointment of government Directors on management Boards of private sector companies.